

**SATYADHEESH**
सत्याधीश

UPSC DAILY DETAILED NOTES

Current Affairs • 2 October 2026

44

NOTES

8

STORIES MERGED

9

MCQS

GS1 • 4

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PAPER MIX

CONTENTS

Every note, grouped by paper

GS1 History • Society • Geography

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18 notes

Polity & Constitution

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Economy

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Agriculture

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Environment & Ecology

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Internal Security

1

Practice — 9 MCQs

HOW EACH NOTE READS

Why in news → facts to remember → a Mains question with keywords. Duplicate stories are merged.

SHORT ON TIME?

The 5-page **Brief** has the stories that matter most, plus a quiz. Same day, same notes.

History & Culture

2

MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

P

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/129424](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/129424)

Mahatma Gandhi led Non-Cooperation and Dandi March movements before assassination in Delhi

WHY IN NEWS Commemoration of Mahatma Gandhi's 157th birth anniversary highlighting his leadership in the Non-Cooperation and Dandi March movements.

- POST** | Mahatma Gandhi was a lawyer by profession before leading the freedom movement.
- PLACE** | Gandhi was born in Porbandar, Gujarat.
- FACT** | Gandhi was assassinated on January 30, 1948.
- PLACE** | The Dandi March is also known as the Salt Satyagraha.

MAINS Q Analyze how Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of Satyagraha and Non-Cooperation served as a catalyst for the mass mobilization of the Indian freedom struggle.

USE: Satyagraha Non-Cooperation Mass Mobilization Salt Satyagraha Non-violence

MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

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M

2 Oct · The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/129332](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/129332)

British East India Company defeated Maratha army to control Delhi in 1803

WHY IN NEWS Historical analysis of the British East India Company's 1803 victory over the Marathas and the subsequent colonial land settlements in Delhi.

- FACT** | The British East India Company defeated the Maratha army to control Delhi in 1803.
- FACT** | Revenue surveys were conducted in 1837 to systematically classify land in the Delhi region.
- PLACE** | Kanjhawala and Raisina are historical localities in Delhi impacted by colonial and modern urban development.

MAINS Q Analyze how colonial land revenue systems and urban planning in Delhi altered traditional land-use patterns and communal rights during the 19th and 20th centuries.

USE: Colonial land tenure Revenue settlement Urban displacement Customary rights Land classification

Geography

2

PLACES IN NEWS / MAPPING

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/129419](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/129419)

India identifies 28 strategic places and geographical features on official Survey of India map

WHY IN NEWS The Government of India formally identified 28 strategic places and geographical features on the official Survey of India map to ensure accurate recognition of territory.

- PLACE** | Zorawar Peak and Kanishka Peak are strategic geographical features in the Ladakh region.
- PLACE** | The Survey of India (Sol) is the national survey and mapping agency of India.
- FACT** | A total of 28 strategic places and geographical features were identified on October 2, 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of accurate cartographic representation in safeguarding India's territorial integrity and managing border security in high-altitude regions.

USE: Cartographic sovereignty Territorial integrity Strategic mapping Border management Geospatial data

Gandak River breaches and Shitalpur dam flood villages as water stays above HFL

WHY IN NEWS Heavy flooding in Bihar caused by Gandak River embankment breaches and Shitalpur dam overflow, necessitating large-scale rescue operations by NDRF and IAF.

- PLACE

Gandak River: A major river in Bihar that flows into the Ganges.
- BODY

NDRF: National Disaster Response Force, a specialized force for disaster management.
- FACT

Flood duration: Water remained above Highest Flood Level (HFL) for 24 to 36 hours on October 1, 2026.
- PLACE

Saran, Gopalganj, Muzaffarpur, West Champaran, and East Champaran: Districts in Bihar affected by the 2026 flood.

MAINS Q *Analyze the structural and hydrological challenges in managing riverine flood risks in the Gangetic plains and suggest measures to enhance disaster resilience.*

USE :

Flood Mitigation

Disaster Resilience

Hydrological Modeling

Embankment Integrity

Inter-agency Coordination

Polity & Constitution

4

ELECTIONS, ECI & ELECTORAL REFORMS

P

3 REPORTS MERGED

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129344

EC directs officers to enroll eligible voters after 13.3 crore names deleted

WHY IN NEWS The Election Commission of India directed Chief Electoral Officers to conduct a special drive to re-enroll eligible voters following the deletion of 13.3 crore names from voter lists.

BODY	Election Commission of India (ECI) is the constitutional body responsible for administering elections to Parliament and State Legislatures.
FACT	Approximately 13.3 crore names were deleted from voter lists leading to the current rectification drive.
FACT	Form 6 is the specific application form used for the enrollment of new voters in the electoral roll.
POST	Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) are the primary state-level authorities responsible for the conduct of elections in their respective States/UTs.

MAINS Q Examine the challenges in maintaining an accurate and inclusive electoral roll in India and suggest measures to ensure universal suffrage.

USE: Universal Adult Franchise Electoral Roll Constitutional Mandate Inclusivity Demographic Accuracy

CONSTITUTION, AMENDMENTS & BASIC STRUCTURE

P

M

2 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/129714

Gujarat receives presidential assent for Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026

WHY IN NEWS Gujarat became the second state after Uttarakhand to receive presidential assent for its Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill 2026, unifying personal laws for residents.

ACT	Gujarat UCC Bill 2026 — Unifies rules for marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships.
CONCEPT	Scheduled Tribes exclusion — The bill explicitly excludes Scheduled Tribes to preserve their customary rights.
FIGURE	Marriageable age — Set at 21 years for men and 18 years for women under the new law.
BODY	Marriage registration — Mandates registration within 60 days and prohibits polygamy.

MAINS Q Examine the constitutional challenges and social implications of implementing a Uniform Civil Code in a diverse country like India while balancing personal laws and tribal rights.

USE: Uniform Civil Code Article 44 Personal Laws Scheduled Tribes Legal Uniformity

STATUTORY, REGULATORY & QUASI-JUDICIAL BODIES

P

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129425

Kerala High Court rules children should not undergo DNA tests for undisputed paternity

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court ruled against mandatory DNA testing for correcting birth records in cases of undisputed paternity, urging legislative amendments to the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969.

ACT / BILL	Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969: Central legislation governing the recording of vital statistics in India.
BODY	Kerala High Court: State judiciary overseeing the application of registration rules in Kerala.
FACT	Rule 11 of Kerala Registration of Births and Deaths Rules, 1999: Specific state rule governing the correction of birth records.

MAINS Q Discuss the balance between the state's interest in accurate civil registration and the protection of individual privacy and dignity in correcting vital records.

USE: Right to Privacy Civil Registration Legislative Amendment Bodily Integrity Administrative Law

Kerala High Court directs Speaker to disqualify Pala MLA Mani C. Kappan after conviction

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court directed the Speaker to disqualify MLA Mani C. Kappan following his conviction in cheque-bounce cases, highlighting the application of the Representation of People Act.

ACT / BILL	Representation of People Act, 1951: Governs the disqualification of members of Parliament and State Legislatures.
BODY	Speaker of the State Legislative Assembly: The presiding officer responsible for maintaining order and deciding on disqualification petitions.
FACT	Mani C. Kappan: Convicted in four cheque-bounce cases and sentenced to 3.5 years imprisonment.

MAINS Q Discuss the constitutional and statutory framework governing the disqualification of legislators in India. How does it ensure the integrity of the legislative body?

USE: Disqualification Representation of People Act Judicial Review Legislative Integrity Constitutional Mandate

Governance

3

Telangana Government to release 2 of 5 pending dearness allowance instalments worth ₹2,500 crore

WHY IN NEWS The Telangana Government announced the release of two pending dearness allowance (DA) instalments worth ₹2,500 crore to state employees.

FACT	The Telangana Government is releasing ₹2,500 crore in dearness allowance (DA) instalments.
FACT	The pending DA instalments have been due since July 1, 2023.
POST	N. Siva Sankar is the head of the Pay Revision Commission in Telangana.

MAINS Q Discuss the fiscal implications and administrative challenges of implementing periodic dearness allowance revisions for state government employees in India.

USE: Fiscal Federalism Dearness Allowance Public Finance Wage Revision State Budgetary Allocation

Supreme Court orders blocking services for motorists with ₹49,194.05 crore in unpaid fines

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court mandated states to block services and blacklist vehicles for motorists with ₹49,194.05 crore in unpaid fines to improve enforcement of traffic regulations.

BODY	Parivahan: The national portal for vehicle-related services in India.
FACT	Total unpaid fines across states ordered for blocking: ₹49,194.05 crore.
FACT	Hyderabad reported 99.22 lakh unpaid challans by late 2025.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in enforcing traffic regulations in urban centers and evaluate the effectiveness of digital platforms like Parivahan in ensuring fiscal compliance.

USE: Fiscal compliance Digital governance Regulatory enforcement Judicial activism Public accountability

Kerala High Court orders Travancore Devaswom Board to provide water and washrooms for pilgrims

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court directed the Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) to improve pilgrim infrastructure and grievance redressal mechanisms at Erumely.

BODY	Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB): A statutory body responsible for the administration of Sabarimala and related shrines.
PLACE	Erumely: A significant pilgrimage site in the Pathanamthitta district of Kerala.
FACT	The court mandated the implementation of CCTV surveillance and a mobile booking app with UPI payment integration.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of judicial activism in ensuring the provision of basic amenities and grievance redressal mechanisms for pilgrims in religious sites.

USE: [Judicial Oversight](#) [Public Amenities](#) [Grievance Redressal](#) [Digital Infrastructure](#) [Statutory Bodies](#)

Social Justice

5

2 REPORTS MERGED

Vijay launches 'Vettri Payanam' offering no-fare travel for 84.32 lakh women and transgender persons

WHY IN NEWS Tamil Nadu CM launched the 'Vettri Payanam' scheme to provide free bus travel for women and transgender persons across seven State Transport Corporations.

SCHEME	Vettri Payanam: Tamil Nadu state government scheme providing free bus travel for women and transgender persons.
FACT	The scheme covers 12,695 buses across seven State Transport Corporations in Tamil Nadu.
FACT	The scheme targets a daily benefit for 84.32 lakh individuals.
PLACE	Koyambedu: Major bus terminus in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.

MAINS Q Discuss how targeted social welfare schemes like free public transport can facilitate gender equality and economic inclusion for marginalized communities in India.

USE: [Gender Equality](#) [Social Inclusion](#) [Public Welfare](#) [Economic Empowerment](#) [Mobility Rights](#)

Satheesan announces separate housing scheme for SC/ST to bypass Life Mission delays

WHY IN NEWS Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan announced a separate housing scheme for SC/ST communities to bypass delays in the Life Mission project.

SCHEME	Life Mission: A flagship housing scheme by the Government of Kerala to provide homes for the homeless.
FACT	Kerala government allocated an additional ₹500 crore for SC/ST welfare schemes in the 2026 budget.
PLACE	Wayanad: Site proposed for the establishment of the world's first tribal university.
POST	V.D. Satheesan: Chief Minister of Kerala (as of October 2026).

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of targeted housing schemes for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in achieving inclusive growth and social justice in India.

USE: [Social Justice](#) [Inclusive Growth](#) [Targeted Welfare](#) [Land Reform](#) [Tribal Empowerment](#)

Kerala hospitals face drug shortages as KMSCL owes pharma firms over ₹2,200 crore

WHY IN NEWS Kerala hospitals are facing critical shortages of essential non-communicable disease drugs due to a ₹2,200 crore debt owed by the Kerala Medical Services Corporation Limited (KMSCL) to pharmaceutical firms.

- BODY** | KMSCL: A Kerala state government undertaking responsible for procuring and distributing medicines to public health facilities.
- FACT** | KMSCL outstanding debt to pharmaceutical firms exceeds ₹2,200 crore as of 2024.
- FACT** | Shortage affects non-communicable diseases (NCDs) including diabetes and hypertension.

MAINS Q Analyze the systemic bottlenecks in public procurement of essential medicines and suggest measures to ensure supply chain resilience in state-run healthcare systems.

USE: Public Procurement Supply Chain Resilience Fiscal Arrears NCD Management Direct Sourcing

Andhra Pradesh HRD Minister Nara Lokesh directs SEEDAP to target 1 lakh youth annually

WHY IN NEWS Andhra Pradesh HRD Minister Nara Lokesh directed the State Employment Exchange Department (SEEDAP) to target the annual employment of 1 lakh youth to boost state-level job placement.

- FACT** | Andhra Pradesh reported a 76% placement rate for skill development programs.
- FACT** | 5.43 lakh youth have secured jobs through skill development programs in Andhra Pradesh.
- BODY** | SEEDAP: State Employment Exchange Department of Andhra Pradesh.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of state-led skill development and employment exchange departments in addressing the structural mismatch between educational output and industrial demand in India.

USE: Skill Development Employment Exchange Human Capital Vocational Training Placement Rate

Kerala Health Minister orders committee to draft Bill regulating medicine costs and room rents

WHY IN NEWS Kerala Health Minister K. Muraleedharan initiated a committee to draft a Bill regulating medicine costs and room rents in private hospitals to address public complaints over exorbitant healthcare expenses.

- BODY** | KMSCL: Kerala Medical Services Corporation Limited, a state-run body for medicine procurement
- FACT** | The committee consists of 4 members including the Director of Health Services and Director of Medical Education

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in regulating private healthcare costs in India while ensuring the quality of service and the sustainability of private healthcare providers.

USE: Affordability Regulatory Framework Public Health Governance Price Ceiling Healthcare Accessibility

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

P

M

2 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/129278

Maninder Sidhu and Piyush Goyal aim to scale Canada and India bilateral trade

WHY IN NEWS India and Canada have initiated the fifth round of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) negotiations to scale bilateral trade to USD 70 billion by 2031.

- FACT** | Target bilateral trade volume between India and Canada: USD 70 billion by 2031
- BODY** | CEPA: Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement being negotiated between India and Canada
- PLACE** | Ottawa: Location of the fifth round of CEPA negotiations starting October 5, 2024
- FACT** | Current bilateral trade baseline: USD 30 billion

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) in diversifying India's supply chains and enhancing its energy security through bilateral trade with Canada.

USE: [Bilateral Trade](#) [Supply Chain Diversification](#) [Critical Minerals](#) [Economic Partnership](#) [Trade Liberalization](#)

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

M

2 REPORTS MERGED

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129373

Putin tells Valdai Modi offers "very good ideas" for Ukraine conflict settlement

WHY IN NEWS President Vladimir Putin acknowledged Prime Minister Narendra Modi's mediation efforts regarding the Ukraine conflict during the Valdai Discussion Club.

- POST** | Vladimir Putin: President of the Russian Federation
- BODY** | Valdai International Discussion Club: A Russian forum for international dialogue
- FACT** | Ukraine conflict commencement: February 2022
- BODY** | BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa

MAINS Q Analyze India's role as a 'bridge' in the Ukraine conflict and discuss the significance of its 'multi-aligned' foreign policy in mediating global geopolitical tensions.

USE: [Strategic Autonomy](#) [Multi-alignment](#) [Peace Mediation](#) [Geopolitical Equilibrium](#) [Global South Leadership](#)

INDIA'S BILATERAL RELATIONS

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129533

Majhi and Sai meet Amit Shah to resolve Mahanadi water dispute

WHY IN NEWS Chief Ministers of Chhattisgarh and Odisha met Union Home Minister Amit Shah to resolve the long-standing Mahanadi water dispute through a technical committee and tribunal.

- BODY** | Central Water Commission (CWC): An apex body under the Ministry of Jal Shakti responsible for water resources management.
- PLACE** | Mahanadi River: A major river in eastern India, flowing through Chhattisgarh and Odisha.
- POST** | Bela M. Trivedi: Current head of the Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal.
- FACT** | Technical committee meeting scheduled for October 13, 2026; Tribunal meeting scheduled for October 15, 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in inter-state river water sharing in India and the role of statutory tribunals in resolving such disputes.

USE: [Inter-state water sharing](#) [Federalism](#) [Riparian rights](#) [Statutory Tribunal](#) [Hydrological security](#)

Global Alliance formed to tackle 18.6 million annual diabetic foot cases in Bengaluru

WHY IN NEWS A global alliance was formed in Bengaluru on October 2, 2026, to combat diabetic foot complications and limb preservation through international cooperation.

- BODY** | DFSI: Diabetic Foot Society of India is a key member of the new global alliance.
- BODY** | WHO: The alliance will collaborate with the World Health Organization for advocacy and data.
- FACT** | The alliance aims to address 18.6 million annual diabetic foot cases globally.
- PLACE** | Bengaluru: The city served as the host for the alliance formation on October 2, 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of multi-lateral healthcare alliances in addressing non-communicable diseases (NCDs) and the role of international cooperation in improving surgical outcomes in developing nations.

USE: Non-communicable diseases Multi-lateral cooperation Limb preservation Public health advocacy Standardized data collection

World food prices hit four-year high due to logistics and El Nino

WHY IN NEWS The FAO reported a surge in world food prices to a four-year high in September 2024 due to logistical bottlenecks and climate phenomena.

- BODY** | FAO: Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
- FIGURE** | 136.0 points: The average level of the FAO Food Price Index in September 2024
- PLACE** | Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint in the Persian Gulf affected by logistics disruptions
- CONCEPT** | El Niño: A climate pattern involving the warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean

MAINS Q Analyze how global geopolitical tensions and climate change interact to destabilize international food security and impact the economies of developing nations.

USE: Food Security Commodity Volatility Geopolitical Risk Climate Resilience Supply Chain Disruption

Nile perch introduction in Lake Victoria destroyed 200 native fish species

WHY IN NEWS The National Invasive Species Information Center reported that the 1954 introduction of Nile perch into Lake Victoria led to the destruction of approximately 200 native fish species.

- CONCEPT** | Nile perch: An invasive predatory fish species introduced for commercial fishing.
- PLACE** | Lake Victoria: A transboundary water body shared by Kenya, Tanzania, and Uganda.
- FIGURE** | 200: The approximate number of native fish species, primarily cichlids, destroyed.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and economic trade-offs involved in introducing invasive species for commercial purposes in shared transboundary water bodies.

USE: Invasive species Biodiversity loss Transboundary water management Ecological impact Cichlids

Economy

7

CAPITAL MARKETS & SEBI

P

2 REPORTS MERGED

2 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/129363**SEBI's FY25-26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses**

WHY IN NEWS SEBI's FY25-26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses, highlighting risks in retail participation in complex financial instruments.

- FACT** | 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses in the FY25-26 SEBI study
- FACT** | Options trading accounted for 92% of the total losses in equity derivatives
- FACT** | Transaction costs of Rs 24,859 crore impacted the profitability of 4.4 lakh traders
- BODY** | SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) is the primary regulator for the securities market in India

MAINS Q Discuss the risks associated with retail participation in complex derivative products and suggest measures to enhance investor protection in capital markets.

USE: Investor Protection Information Asymmetry Market Volatility Financial Literacy Regulatory Oversight

GROWTH, INFLATION & MACRO INDICATORS

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129716**Economists propose OECD countries pay Global South individuals for climate damage**

WHY IN NEWS Economists Michael Greenstone, Abhijit Banerjee, and Esther Duflo proposed a 'Just Economics' model where OECD countries pay Global South individuals directly for climate damages caused by historical emissions.

- CONCEPT** | Just Economics: A model where OECD countries pay Global South individuals directly for climate damages caused by historical emissions.
- CONCEPT** | Carbon Pricing: A condition for direct payments, with bilateral deals suggested as an alternative to global consensus.
- BODY** | OECD: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, a grouping of mostly wealthy, industrialized countries.
- FIGURE** | 82%: Projected percentage of future global emissions expected to originate outside of OECD countries.
- PLACE** | Surat: Site of a 99% compliant market trial of 150 textile plants for emissions trading.

MAINS Q Critically analyze the feasibility of direct-to-individual climate reparations from the Global North to the Global South as a mechanism for climate justice.

USE: Climate Justice Carbon Pricing Global South Climate Reparations Market-based Solutions

INFRASTRUCTURE (ENERGY, PORTS, ROADS, RAILWAYS)

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129698**Railway Board approves first Vande Bharat Sleeper for South India to Mumbai**

WHY IN NEWS The Railway Board approved the first Vande Bharat Sleeper Express connecting KSR Bengaluru to Mumbai (CSMT) to enhance high-speed rail connectivity in South India.

- CONCEPT** | Vande Bharat Sleeper Express — first such service launched for the South Indian region
- BODY** | Railway Board — apex body responsible for the management of Indian Railways
- PLACE** | KSR Bengaluru and CSMT Mumbai — the primary terminals for the new sleeper service

MAINS Q Discuss how the expansion of high-speed rail infrastructure like the Vande Bharat Express contributes to regional integration and economic connectivity in India.

USE: Regional Integration Logistics Efficiency Infrastructure Development Modal Shift Economic Connectivity

CURE Act 2026 shifts Hyderabad property tax to Capital Value System

WHY IN NEWS The introduction of the CURE Act 2026 replaces the GHMC Act 1955, shifting property tax to a Capital Value System and altering local governance in Hyderabad's urban regions.

ACT | CURE Act: Core Urban Region (Integrated Governance) Act, 2026

ACT | GHMC Act, 1955: The previous legislation replaced by the CURE Act

CONCEPT | Capital Value System: A property tax model based on market value rather than annual rental value

PLACE | CMC: Cyberabad Municipal Corporation governed under the new Act

MAINS Q Discuss the implications of shifting to a Capital Value System for property taxation on urban infrastructure development and municipal fiscal autonomy.

USE: Fiscal Federalism

Municipal Governance

Capital Value System

Urban Planning

Taxation Policy

Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka announces ₹52,000 crore infrastructure works for Hyderabad by October 2026

WHY IN NEWS Deputy CM Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka announced a ₹52,000 crore infrastructure package for Hyderabad to be completed by October 2026, focusing on metro expansion and regional connectivity.

FACT | Total infrastructure investment for Hyderabad announced on October 02, 2026: ₹52,000 crore

FACT | Metro Rail expansion budget: ₹38,000 crore

FACT | Regional Ring Road budget: ₹30,627 crore

BODY | TSRTC: Telangana State Road Transport Corporation

MAINS Q Discuss how integrated multi-modal transport systems and regional ring roads can alleviate urban congestion and foster economic decentralization in rapidly growing Indian metropolitan hubs.

USE: Multi-modal transport

Urban decongestion

Regional connectivity

Infrastructure investment

Transit-oriented development

PNGRB launches National PNG Drive 3.0 to enroll 50 lakh domestic-piped gas connections

WHY IN NEWS PNGRB launched National PNG Drive 3.0 to accelerate domestic piped natural gas (PNG) penetration as part of India's net-zero transition.

BODY | PNGRB: The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board is the statutory body regulating the oil and natural gas sector in India.

FACT | National PNG Drive 3.0 target: 50 lakh domestic-piped gas connections by fiscal year 2027.

FACT | National PNG Drive 3.0 active user target: 40 lakh connections to be converted into active users.

FACT | National PNG Drive 2.0 closure report: Released on July 7, 2026.

MAINS Q Examine the role of piped natural gas (PNG) infrastructure in achieving India's net-zero goals and the challenges in transitioning from LPG to PNG.

USE: Net-zero goals

Energy transition

Last-mile connectivity

Regulatory framework

Infrastructure development

Karnataka approves Sustainable Data Centre Policy to reach 1GW capacity by 2031

WHY IN NEWS Karnataka approved the Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026–2031 to establish a 1GW data centre capacity by 2031 while promoting energy and water efficiency.

- FACT** | Target capacity: 1GW of data centre capacity by 2031
- FACT** | PUE: Power Usage Effectiveness is a metric for data centre energy efficiency
- FACT** | WUE: Water Usage Effectiveness measures water consumption per unit of IT load
- PLACE** | Karnataka: State government approving the Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026–2031

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of sustainable data infrastructure in India's digital economy and the environmental challenges posed by high-intensity data processing.

USE: Sustainable Infrastructure Digital Economy Resource Efficiency PUE WUE

Agriculture

3

Andhra Pradesh announces ₹2.3 lakh crore for rural development and horticulture

WHY IN NEWS Andhra Pradesh CM N. Chandrababu Naidu announced a massive ₹2.3 lakh crore investment plan for rural development and Rayalaseema horticulture during the Swarnandhra–Swachhandhra Awards–2026.

- FIGURE** | ₹1.30 lakh crore — allocated for rural development in Andhra Pradesh
- FIGURE** | ₹1 lakh crore — allocated specifically for horticulture in Rayalaseema
- PLACE** | Rayalaseema — a geographical region in the southern part of Andhra Pradesh
- CONCEPT** | Net-Zero goals — supported via MoU with IIT-Kanpur for schools

MAINS Q Discuss how targeted regional investments in horticulture and rural infrastructure can drive inclusive economic growth and climate resilience in agrarian states like Andhra Pradesh.

USE: Inclusive growth Horticultural development Net-Zero goals Rural infrastructure Regional disparity

Karnataka faces ₹46,324.5 crore crop losses; government requests ₹3,705.30 crore in aid

WHY IN NEWS The Karnataka government requested ₹3,705.30 crore in aid from the Centre due to ₹46,324.5 crore in crop losses caused by deficit rainfall.

- BODY** | SDRF: State Disaster Response Fund provides immediate relief for natural calamities.
- BODY** | NDRF: National Disaster Response Fund is the central fund for disaster management.
- FACT** | Karnataka reported crop losses of ₹46,324.5 crore across 47.09 lakh hectares.
- PLACE** | Karnataka: State currently facing drought in 177 taluks.

MAINS Q Discuss the limitations of current disaster relief funds in addressing large-scale agricultural losses caused by climate-induced droughts in India.

USE: Climate Resilience Disaster Mitigation Fiscal Federalism Agricultural Distress SDRF Norms

Food Ministry tightens sugar stock limits to 1,000 quintals for festival season

WHY IN NEWS The Food Ministry tightened sugar stock-holding limits to 1,000 quintals for a 15-day period starting October 15, 2026, to prevent hoarding and ensure price stability during the festival season.

- FACT | Sugar stock limit for most regions: 1,000 quintals from October 15 to November 30, 2026
- FACT | Sugar stock limit for Kolkata and Assam: 2,000 quintals
- FACT | Retail sugar prices fell by 15% from August 2026 peaks
- FACT | Ex-mill sugar prices dropped by approximately 28% by October 2026

MAINS Q Discuss the role of administrative interventions in regulating commodity stock-holding limits to ensure food security and price stability in India.

USE:

Price Stability

Stock-holding Limits

Food Security

Market Intervention

Supply Chain Management

Science & Technology

7

UNFCCC Executive Secretary praises Rs 1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

WHY IN NEWS UNFCCC Executive Secretary Simon Stiell praised India's approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) for its scale in evacuating renewable energy.

- FACT | GEC-III total project outlay: Rs 1.86 lakh crore
- FACT | Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) capacity: 50 GWh
- FACT | Renewable energy evacuation target: 135 GW
- FACT | Central Financial Assistance (CFA) for GEC-III: Rs 54,082 crore
- BODY | UNFCCC: United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

MAINS Q Examine how the development of large-scale battery energy storage systems and transmission corridors can address the intermittency challenges of India's renewable energy transition.

USE:

Renewable Energy Transition

Grid Stability

Energy Storage Systems

Decarbonization

Infrastructure Development

Jessica Watkins becomes first Black woman to lead crew to orbit in record flight

WHY IN NEWS SpaceX successfully launched a four-person crew to the International Space Station (ISS) in a record-breaking 8-hour journey, featuring the first Black woman to lead a crew to orbit.

- S&T | SpaceX: A private American aerospace manufacturer and space transportation company.
- PLACE | Cape Canaveral Space Force Station: A primary spaceport located in Florida, USA.
- S&T | International Space Station (ISS): A modular space station in low Earth orbit for scientific research.
- FACT | The crew reached the ISS in a record-breaking 8-hour flight time.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of private-public partnerships in space exploration and their role in accelerating technological milestones for humanity.

USE:

SpaceX

ISS

Aerospace

Public-Private Partnership

Orbital Mechanics

Spintronics AI and CSIR-CEERI sign MoU for indigenous GaN fabrication facility

WHY IN NEWS Spintronics AI and CSIR-CEERI signed an MoU on October 02, 2026, to establish an indigenous Gallium Nitride (GaN) fabrication facility to bolster India's semiconductor manufacturing capabilities.

CONCEPT	Gallium Nitride (GaN) — a wide-bandgap semiconductor material used in high-frequency and high-power electronics.
BODY	CSIR-CEERI — Central Electronics Engineering Research Institute, a premier R&D laboratory under CSIR.
FIGURE	GaN market projection — expected to grow from \$224 million in 2026 to \$1.88 billion by 2033.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of developing indigenous wide-bandgap semiconductor technologies like Gallium Nitride (GaN) for India's technological sovereignty and electronics manufacturing ecosystem.

USE: Semiconductor fabrication Wide-bandgap semiconductors Technological sovereignty Indigenous manufacturing R&D collaboration

CCMB scientists develop India-specific Severity Score to improve clinical assessment concordance to 85%

WHY IN NEWS CCMB scientists developed India-specific Severity Scores (ISS1 and ISS2) to improve clinical assessment accuracy for pediatric patients.

BODY	CCMB: CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology is a premier research institute in India.
FACT	ISS1 and ISS2 improved clinical assessment concordance to 85% compared to 67% for PSS scores.
PLACE	Government Medical College and Hospital, Nagpur, served as the study site.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of developing indigenous clinical assessment tools in improving healthcare outcomes for vulnerable populations in India.

USE: Clinical Concordance Diagnostic Standardization Indigenous Innovation Pediatric Healthcare Public Health Metrics

Tamil Nadu launches first booth-less toll plaza using FASTag, RFID and ANPR technology

WHY IN NEWS Tamil Nadu launched its first booth-less toll plaza at Paranur using FASTag, RFID, and ANPR technology to automate toll collection and reduce traffic congestion.

S&T	ANPR (Automatic Number Plate Recognition) uses Optical Character Recognition (OCR) to identify vehicle plates.
FACT	The booth-less system applies a 100% penalty (twice the fee) for users without tags or sufficient balance.
FACT	A 50% discount is applicable on the penalty fee if paid within 72 hours of the e-notice.
PLACE	Paranur toll plaza is located on the Chennai-Tiruchi National Highway in Tamil Nadu.

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of RFID and ANPR technologies in infrastructure projects can enhance logistical efficiency and reduce carbon footprints in India's transport sector.

USE: Multi-lane free flow Logistical efficiency Carbon footprint Automated enforcement Digital infrastructure

Gursaran Prasad Talwar developed first leprosy and birth control vaccines before founding NII

WHY IN NEWS The upcoming centenary of Gursaran Prasad Talwar, a pioneer in immunology who developed the first leprosy and birth control vaccines and founded the National Institute of Immunology (NII).

- POST** | Gursaran Prasad Talwar: Pioneer in immunology and founder of the National Institute of Immunology (NII).
- BODY** | National Institute of Immunology (NII): Established in 1983 in New Delhi.
- FACT** | Leprosy and birth control vaccines: First vaccines of their kind developed by Talwar.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of indigenous vaccine development and institutional research in strengthening India's public health infrastructure and achieving universal health coverage.

USE: Immunology Vaccine Development Public Health Infrastructure Neglected Tropical Diseases Biotechnology

Google launches Planet Labs satellite on SpaceX rocket to test Tensor Processing Unit

WHY IN NEWS Google launched a Planet Labs satellite via a SpaceX rocket to test its Tensor Processing Unit (TPU) in orbit as part of Project Suncatcher.

- S&T** | Tensor Processing Unit (TPU): Google's custom-developed AI accelerator chip designed to accelerate machine learning workloads.
- S&T** | Project Suncatcher: Google's initiative to develop large-scale compute clusters in orbit around Earth.
- FACT** | Starship target cost: \$200 per kilogram by 2035 (as per Joule white paper).
- S&T** | Laser communications: Proposed technology for future purpose-built satellites to collaborate in orbit.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of orbital computing and space-based AI infrastructure in the evolution of global data processing and high-performance computing.

USE: Orbital Computing Tensor Processing Unit Space Infrastructure Edge Computing Space AI

Environment & Ecology

4

Idukki administration clears natural passages to mitigate human-wildlife conflicts

WHY IN NEWS The Idukki district administration and Forest Department are clearing natural passages in the Devikulam forest range to mitigate escalating human-wildlife conflicts.

- PLACE** | Chinnakkanal and Devikulam forest range — locations in Idukki district, Kerala where passages are being cleared.
- CONCEPT** | Human-wildlife conflict — resulted in 81 deaths and 486 injuries over a decade in the region.
- FIGURE** | 10 deaths — recorded specifically during the 2023-24 period in the area.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and socio-economic challenges of human-wildlife conflict in fragmented habitats and evaluate the efficacy of translocation as a mitigation strategy.

USE: Human-wildlife conflict Habitat fragmentation Wildlife translocation Corridor restoration Biodiversity conservation

Survey records 65 distinct vultures including 54 white-rumped and 11 red-headed in Wayanad

WHY IN NEWS A synchronous survey in Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary recorded 65 vultures, providing critical baseline data for monitoring critically endangered scavengers in the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve.

ENVIRONMENT	White-rumped vulture (<i>Gyps bengalensis</i>) and Red-headed vulture (<i>Gyps bengalensis</i>) are critically endangered scavengers.
PLACE	Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary is located within the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve in Kerala.
FACT	The survey recorded 65 distinct vultures across 108 observations over a two-day period.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological significance of vultures in waste management and the primary threats leading to their population decline in the Indian subcontinent.

USE: Biodiversity conservation Scavenger ecology Zoonotic disease Habitat fragmentation Critically endangered

Bhupender Yadav and Suwendu Adhikari release three-year-old tigress T138 into Buxa Tiger Reserve

WHY IN NEWS Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari released tigress T138 from Valmiki Tiger Reserve to Buxa Tiger Reserve to mark the start of World Wildlife Week 2026.

PLACE	Buxa Tiger Reserve: Located in the state of West Bengal.
PLACE	Valmiki Tiger Reserve: Located in the state of Bihar.
FACT	The tiger population augmentation project spans the financial years 2023-24 to 2027-28.
ENVIRONMENT	World Wildlife Week 2026: Commenced on October 02, 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and logistical challenges involved in tiger translocation projects to ensure the long-term survival of relocated individuals in new habitats.

USE: Translocation Habitat Augmentation Biodiversity Conservation In-situ Conservation Wildlife Management

2026 marks lowest monsoon in a decade as El Nino causes drought threshold deficit

WHY IN NEWS The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that 2026 recorded the lowest monsoon rainfall in a decade due to a strengthening El Nino and a neutral Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD).

FACT	India's 2026 monsoon rainfall was 759.4 mm, representing 87% of the 868.6 mm LPA.
S&T	El Nino is a climate pattern characterized by the warming of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific Ocean.
S&T	The Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) remained neutral during the 2026 monsoon season.
FACT	East and Northeast India recorded 1,016.3 mm of rainfall in 2026, the lowest since 1901.
BODY	The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the primary agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.

MAINS Q Analyze the impact of El Nino and the Indian Ocean Dipole on India's monsoon patterns and discuss strategies to mitigate drought-induced agricultural risks.

USE: El Nino Indian Ocean Dipole Monsoon Deficit Climate Variability Drought Threshold

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129436

Manipur Cabinet approves ₹10 lakh assistance for kin of 49 missing since May 3

WHY IN NEWS The Manipur Cabinet approved financial assistance for kin of missing persons and increased ex-gratia for security forces amidst the ongoing ethnic conflict.

- FACT** | 49 people have been reported missing since the ethnic conflict began on May 3, 2023
- FACT** | The ethnic conflict in Manipur has resulted in 306 deaths and over 60,000 displacements
- POST** | Yunman Khemchand Singh serves as the Chief Minister of Manipur
- FACT** | The Cabinet approved a one-time ₹10 lakh assistance for kin of missing persons

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in managing internal ethnic conflicts and the role of state-central coordination in ensuring the safety of displaced populations in Manipur.

USE : Internal Security Ethnic Conflict Displacement Ex-gratia Law and Order

9 questions, 9 minutes

Answers at the bottom, upside down

1 With reference to the rural development investments in Andhra Pradesh, consider the following statements:

1. The government allocated ₹1.30 lakh crore specifically for horticulture in the Rayalaseema region.
2. The investment plan was announced during the Swarnandhra-Swachhandhra Awards-2020.
3. A total of ₹2.3 lakh crore was announced for rural development and Rayalaseema horticulture.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 only ☐ b 3 only
☐ c 1 and 2 only ☐ d 1 and 3 only

2 With reference to the Gujarat Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, consider the following statements:

1. The bill unifies rules for marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships.
2. The bill explicitly excludes Scheduled Tribes to preserve their customary rights.
3. The bill mandates marriage registration within 30 days of the wedding.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 only ☐ b 2 only
☐ c 1 and 2 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

3 With reference to the 'Just Economics' model and climate finance, consider the following statements:

1. The model proposes direct-to-individual payments rather than government transfers.
2. Bilateral deals are suggested as a viable alternative to global consensus.
3. Projected 82% of future global emissions are expected to originate inside of OECD countries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 only ☐ b 2 only
☐ c 1 and 2 only ☐ d 1 and 3 only

4 With reference to the Vande Bharat Sleeper Express, consider the following statements:

1. It is the first Vande Bharat Sleeper service launched for the South Indian region.
2. The service operates only on weekdays.
3. The service connects KSR Bengaluru to Mumbai (CSMT).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 3 only ☐ b 1 and 2 only
☐ c 1 and 3 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

5 With reference to human-wildlife conflict in the Idukki district, consider the following statements:

1. The 2023-24 period recorded 20 deaths due to human-wildlife conflict in the region.
2. The region recorded 81 deaths and 486 injuries over a 10-year period.
3. The initiative involves clearing natural passages in the Devikulam forest range.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 and 2 only ☐ b 1 and 3 only
☐ c 2 and 3 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

6 With reference to the CURE Act 2026, consider the following statements:

1. The Capital Value System calculates property tax based on annual rental value.
2. The Act governs the Cyberabad Municipal Corporation (CMC).
3. The Act replaces the GHMC Act 1955 for municipal governance in Hyderabad.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 2 only ☐ b 1 and 2 only
☐ c 2 and 3 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

- 7 With reference to Gallium Nitride (GaN) and the recent MoU, consider the following statements:
1. CSIR-CEERI is a premier R&D laboratory under the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research.
 2. The GaN market is projected to reach \$1.88 billion by the year 2026.
 3. GaN is a wide-bandgap semiconductor material used in high-frequency and high-power electronics.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

- 8 With reference to the FAO Food Price Index and global food prices, consider the following statements:
1. Logistics disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and the Black Sea contributed to the price hike.
 2. The FAO Food Price Index reached an average of 136.0 points in September 2024.
 3. The surge in world food prices was primarily driven by the cooling of surface waters in the Pacific Ocean.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

- 9 Which three countries share Lake Victoria, where the Nile perch was introduced?

- (a) Nigeria, Ghana, and Cameroon (b) South Africa, Namibia, and Botswana
(c) Kenya, Tanzania, and Uganda (d) Egypt, Sudan, and Ethiopia

(c) 6 (a) 8 (c) 7 (c) 6 (c) 5 (c) 4 (c) 3 (c) 2 (b) 1 • ANSWERS



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